

Tirthankar (Tirth) Ray

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Pharma operations and R&D management leader with 20+ years building and scaling cross-functional teams across global capability centers. Built a 120-person organization spanning 62 countries at BMS, owning end-to-end program management for clinical and commercial operations with full budget accountability (\$70M+ in cost optimization). Deep expertise in stakeholder alignment across Medical Affairs, IT, Commercial, and Supply Chain functions. Led organizational change programs, talent acquisition and development strategies, regulatory compliance frameworks, and vendor management at enterprise scale across Novartis, Pfizer, BMS, and IQVIA. Strong track record in operational excellence, quality metrics, process improvement, and strategic resource allocation within the life sciences industry.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Global People Leadership

Program & Project Management

Budget & Financial Management

Organizational Change Management

Stakeholder & Health Authority Alignment

Talent Acquisition & Development

Operational Excellence & Quality Metrics

Pharma R&D Operations & Regulatory Compliance

WORK EXPERIENCE

Improzo (Pharma Analytics & Technology Consulting)

Mar 2026 -- Present

VP, Data & AI -- Platform Architecture & GCC Enablement | Hyderabad

- Leading solution architecture for pharma GCC clients (Novartis, BMS, Amgen, Sanofi) -- translating complex business requirements into scalable platform capabilities and multi-year technology roadmaps
- Defining governance and stewardship frameworks for client engagements: FAIR principles, data lineage automation, metadata catalogs, and quality scorecards embedded into delivery
- Architecting enterprise-grade data platforms and AI/ML solution frameworks across data ingestion, integration, modeling, and consumption layers for R&D and commercial use cases
- Designing end-to-end data product blueprints spanning CRM pipelines, claims data lakes, HCP/HCO master data graphs, and real-time analytics engines on Databricks and Snowflake

Bristol Myers Squibb (BMS)

Jan 2023 -- Feb 2026

Head, Commercial Business Insights & Technology -- GCC | Hyderabad

- Built and led 120+ person globally distributed team** across data engineering, analytics, AI/ML, and program management spanning 62 countries with 80+ engagement scores and zero major escalations
- Delivered \$70M+ in cost optimization** through strategic vendor transitions, resource allocation planning, and in-house capability building
- Defined multi-year strategic roadmaps aligning platform capabilities with business priorities across Oncology, Immunology, and Cardiovascular therapeutic areas
- Established governance frameworks (FAIR principles, Clean Core strategy) with accountability for data ownership, lineage, quality, and lifecycle management
- Led Veeva CRM-to-Vault migration with Accenture -- complex, cross-functional program with global scope, risk management, and dependency coordination
- Drove platform adoption via standardized delivery frameworks and KPIs, eliminating 500+ static dashboards through self-service analytics

Anervea (GRG Health)

2022 -- 2023

SVP -- Commercial Intelligence & Advisory | Hyderabad

- Strategic advisory on platform design and commercial analytics transformation for pharma clients, driving 20% cost reduction in operations
- Designed enterprise data product strategy and reusable analytics frameworks for field force effectiveness, HCP targeting, and market access
- Led cross-functional teams across data engineering and analytics to deliver scalable solutions with measurable business impact

Pfizer India

2020 -- 2022

Lead -- Customer Enablement & Commercial Technology | Mumbai / Hyderabad

- Led commercial technology transformation enabling 2,000+ field reps and 300K HCPs -- implementing Veeva CRM and SAP integrations at enterprise scale
- Managed cross-functional stakeholder alignment across IT, Commercial, Medical, and Supply Chain teams for platform rollouts across India
- Implemented Reltio MDM for HCP/HCO master data management, improving data quality, deduplication, and lineage tracking
- Established delivery discipline and governance models for multi-stakeholder, cross-functional programs

Novartis

2015 -- 2020

Senior Manager -- Sales Force Effectiveness & Commercial Analytics | Hyderabad

- Established and scaled Commercial Services GCC from ground up -- building high-performing analytics and data teams for APAC and global markets
- Led automation initiatives reducing manual reporting effort by 40%, enabling reusable data products and self-service reporting
- Designed incentive compensation systems, sales force alignment tools, and territory optimization platforms across multiple countries
- Harmonized SFE processes across APAC markets, driving standardization and adoption of enterprise platforms

IQVIA (Cegedim)

2012 -- 2015

Product Manager -- Sales Force Automation | Gurugram

- Managed enterprise SFA product requirements for US pharma clients -- HCP persona development, mobile applications, and MDM modernization
- Drove product roadmaps and commercialization plans for life sciences customer master solutions serving top-20 US pharma accounts

Cognizant Technology Solutions

2007 -- 2012

Senior Associate -- Business Analyst | Gurugram

- Managed business requirements for Pfizer's alignment and incentive tools across the US market, ensuring data quality and platform reliability
- Designed and administered incentive compensation schemes for global pharmaceutical clients across therapeutic areas

EDUCATION

Advanced Certification in Computational Data Science -- Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Bangalore	2022 -- 2024
Post Graduate Diploma in Management (PGDM) -- Management Development Institute (MDI), Gurugram	2010 -- 2012
Bachelor of Technology, Mechanical Engineering -- Indian Institute of Technology (IIT), Mumbai	1998 -- 2002

CERTIFICATIONS & RECOGNITION

AIGP (AI Governance Professional) -- IAPP (in progress)
Veeva CRM Certified
ZS GCC Summit 2026 -- Panelist on AI and Agentic AI in Pharmaceutical GCCs
BMS 2024 Global Hackfest Winner | 2025 Best Commercial Idea | 2025 ReWired Award for Quality

SKILLS

Pharma Systems: Veeva CRM & Vault, Salesforce Marketing Cloud, Model N, Reltio MDM, SAP BTP
Data Platforms: Databricks, Snowflake, AWS (S3, Glue, Bedrock, SageMaker), Azure
Governance: Informatica, Collibra, FAIR Frameworks, MDM, Data Lineage, Metadata Catalogs
Analytics & BI: Python, SQL, R, Power BI, Tableau, Looker **Infrastructure:** CI/CD Pipelines, Docker, Git, Terraform, Airflow, dbt
Languages: English (Professional), Hindi (Native), Bengali (Native)